Writers Group - July, 2003 Word count - 657
Estelle El-Hai

PRINCESS SARINA AND THE FROG

Because she was the only child in the palace, princess Sarina learned to amuse herself with her surroundings. She took long walks in the nearby forest and befriended the small creatures that dwelled there. The trees seemed to be aware of her presence and would flutter their leaves as she strolled through the fragrant paths.

Sarina did not fear the insects. She marveled at their beautiful colors and graceful motion as they swooped through the foliage. The soft breeze played with her shiny chestnut hair as she stooped to breathe the sweet bouquet offered by delicate wild flowers. Sarina was content with her young life, although she missed the presence of a companion with whom she could discuss the books she loved, her secret longings, and her ambition to make a contribution to mankind.

The princess often thought about how she could help to eliminate wars and bring about a better appreciation for nature and all the wonders that too many people did not see. It pained her to realize how small and large animals were mistreated because she truly cared for all living things.

One day, after strolling through her beloved woods, she came upon a brook of clear water and crouched down to satisfy her thirst. The drink was cool and delicious but unknowingly, Sarina swallowed a frog's egg which floated in the water.

The incident did not seem to make any difference until Sarina began to feel a bit jumpy days later. Her chestnut hair took on a green glow, which was quite attractive. It was this new restlessness that

made her fidgety and caused her to run through the forest as quickly as she could. There were times when she would literally leap from shrub to shrub, and it felt so exciting.

The royal parents were too busy managing the estate and the village to notice any change in their daughter. Sarina's inner turbulence continued until one night, when she experienced a strange dream. She envisioned a pond with colorful floating flowers, and on one of the broad, shiny leaves sat the most charming frog she had ever seen. As Sarina blinked her eyes, the pond disappeared, but the attractive frog remained, sitting on her green satin pillow!

"Well hello there", exclaimed Sarina. "Where did you come from?"

"I sort of drifted out of your body dear princess" said the frog in a velvety voice.

"I never thought a frog could talk", said the surprised princess.

"And I never knew anyone who could understand me", was the reply.

At last, here was the companion that Sarina had yearned for. The frog was so compassionate and understanding. They spoke of many things and tried to solve the problems of the land. He was funny too and would perform many tricks that would cause the princess to laugh until her sides ached.

Months passed and the two friends grew closer and more precious to each other. One moonlit night, when the light sparkled on the smooth pond, Sarina found that her heart was overflowing with love for her dear friend. She gathered him up in her hands, drew him to her lips, and placed a warm kiss on his face. The leaves on the trees

rustled loudly, and flowers swirled around them in a cloud. When the turbulence quieted down, there on a shiny green leaf, sat two blissful frogs. One was adorned with a tiny crown and she whispered, "What has happened?"

"You have broken the spell dear Sarina. It was destined that you join the world of nature's creatures and become my bride" said the velvety voice.

The wedding took place near the pond and was attended by all the friendly creatures that Sarina and her new mate loved. Not too long afterwards, they were blessed with twins, whom they named Robert and Ribbit.

They lived happily ever after.

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P.S. My twelve year old granddaughter, Sarina, and I are pen pals. She is crazy about frogs and frog figures. She even has a frog "shrine" with candles around it. The worst part about it is that she makes a frog face and voice which I can't stand. My spurning of her character hurt her feelings, so I suggested a new tact where we would compose a story and take turns with the installments. I was to start it but when I got into it, I couldn't stop. My plan is to submit to her the first page and let her continue. When "ours" is completed, I will send her this draft which I present to you.